

Features
New Artwork

CYBERPUNKTM

THE ROLEPLAYING GAME OF THE DARK FUTURE

"Got the
chips and
enhance-
ments—

"Got the
Attitude
right—

"Got the
Metal
beneath my
skin—

"I'm chippin'
in..."

—Johnny
Silverhand



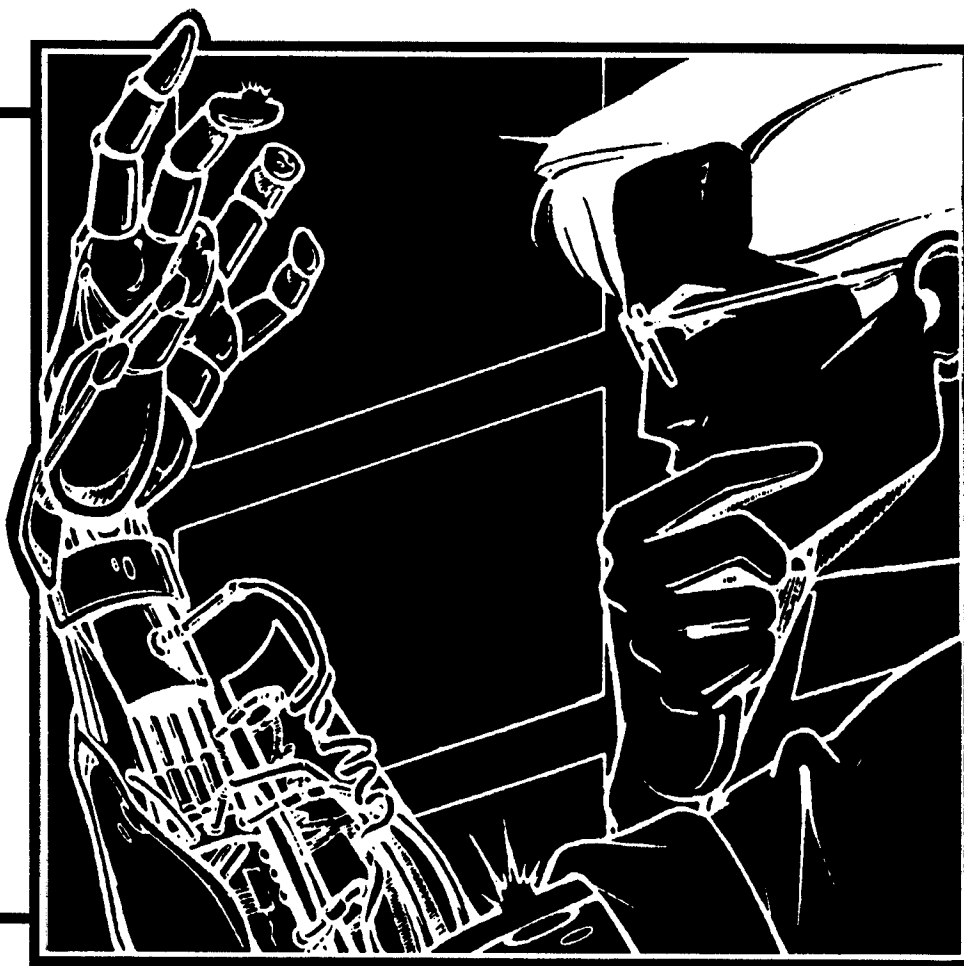
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THE SECOND EDITION

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CP 3002

CYBERPUNK

THE ROLEPLAYING GAME OF THE DARK FUTURE

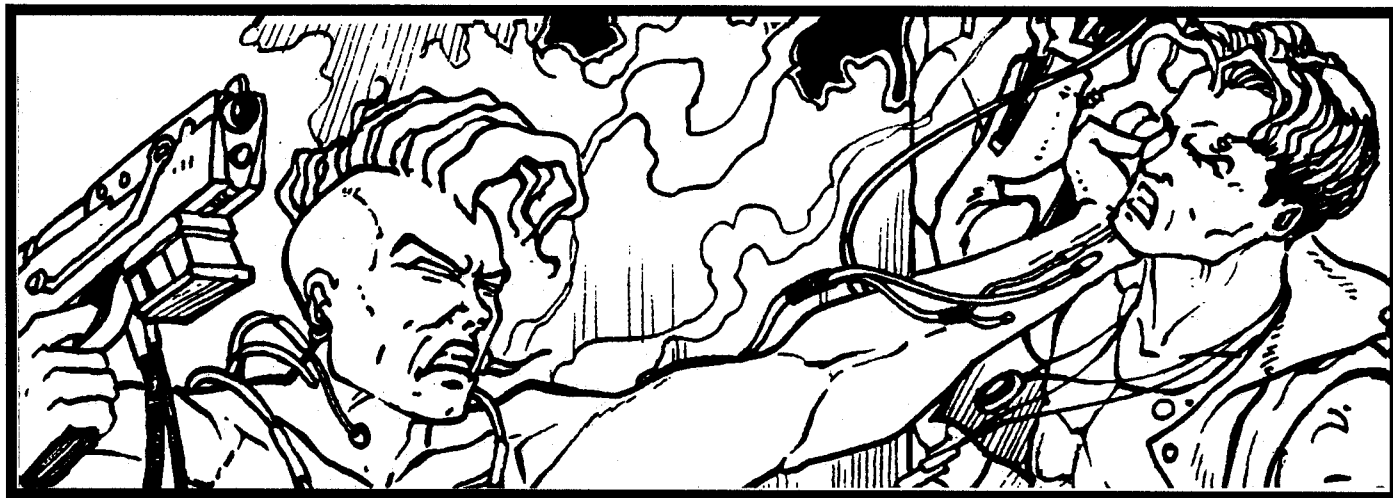


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VERSION 2.01

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Contains corrections and clarifications to CYBERPUNK 2.0.2.0., Version 2.0, including bound-in version of SCREAMSHEETS adventures and new artwork. For a free CP 2.0.2.0. update to bring your Version 1.0 online with the new data in this version, as well as a free DATA SCREEN correction overlay, just send an SASE to R. Talsorian Games, Inc. P.O. Box 7356, Dept H, Berkeley, CA. 94707.

CYBERPUNK



2-0-2-0
THE SECOND EDITION

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To Lisa.

What a long, strange trip it's been!

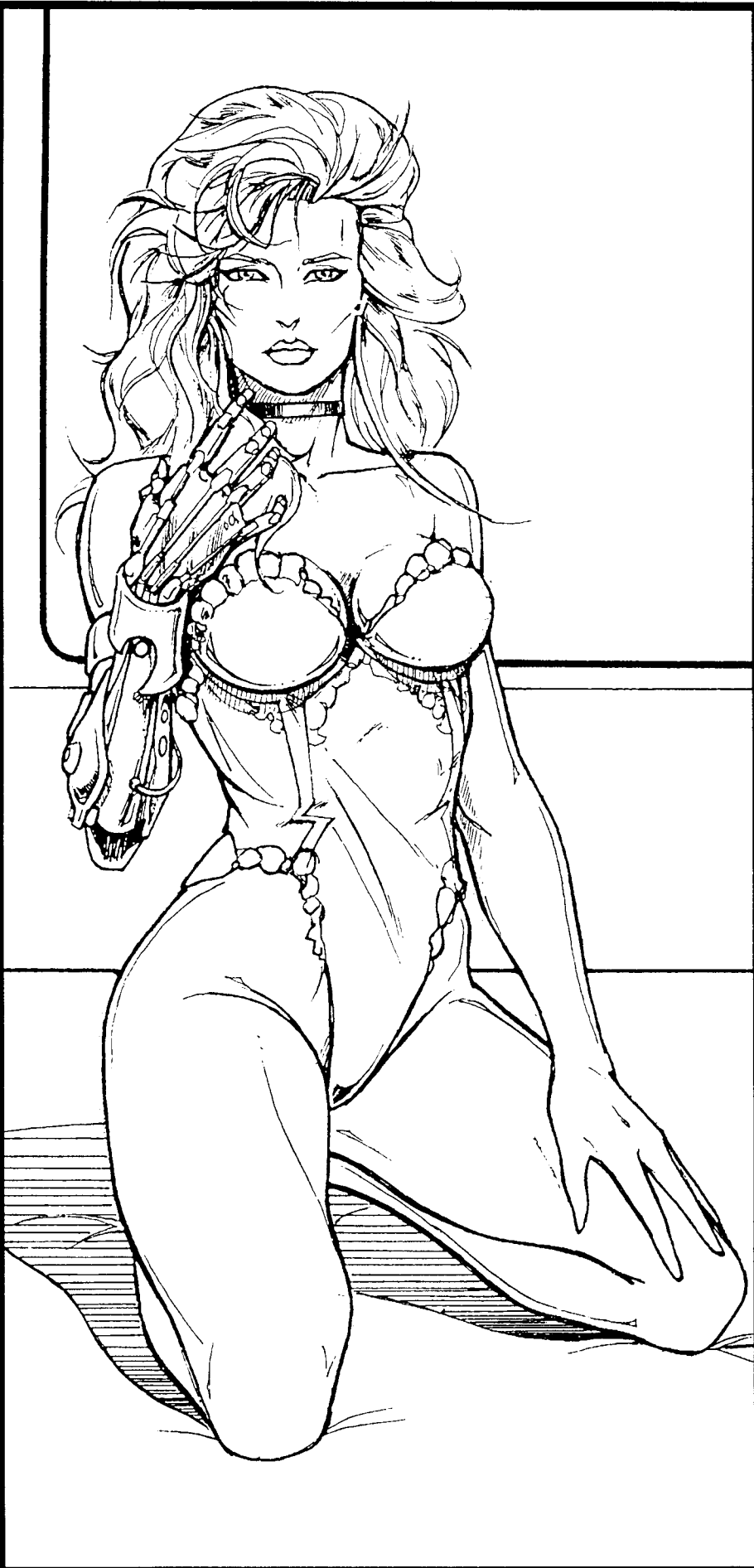
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ROLES
CHARACTERS
LIFEPATH
TASK & SKILLS
WEAPONS
ARMOR
GEAR
CYBERWEAR
COMBAT
MEDICAL
NETRUNNING

**VIEW
FROM
THE
EDGE**



As a Cyberpunk, you grab technology by the throat and hang on. You've got interface plugs in your wrists, weapons in your arms, lasers in your eyes. biochip programs in your brain. You become the car you drive, the gun you shoot...With cyborged fingers you pick computer locks; with enhanced senses, you see into the Future.

SECTION **1 SOUL & THE NEW MACHINE**

The world of Cyberpunk is a violent, dangerous place, filled with people who'd love to rip your arm off and eat it. The traditional concepts of good and evil are replaced by the values of expedience—you do what you have to do to survive. If you can do some good along the way, great.

But don't count on it.

Cyberpunk characters are survivors in a tough, grim world, faced with life and death choices. How they make these choices will have a lot to do with whether they end up as vicious animals roaming a ruined world, or retain something of their basic humanity. Cyberpunk characters are the heroes of a bad situation, working to make it better (or at least survivable) whenever

they can. Whether it takes committing crimes, defying authority or even outright revolution, the quintessential Cyberpunk character is a rebel

**"Always take
it to the
Edge. It's the
Cyberpunk
way."**

**—Johnny
Silverhand**

with a cause. As a Cyberpunk role-player, it's up to you to find that cause and go to the wall with it.

This is the essence of Cyberpunk—playing your character with the proper disaffected, cynical-yet-idealistic style. Whether you're a biker with leathered skin and metal claws, or a debutante in satin sporting the latest in designer cyberoptics, you're going to need a certain panache—a certain flair, in portraying yourself. To achieve the essence of the 2000's, you need to master three concepts:

THE VIEW FROM THE EDGE

*"I'm not a man /or a machine.
I'm just something in between.
I'm all love / a dynamo
So push the button and let me go."
Lovin' Every Minute of It
1984 Zomba Enterprises Inc. (ASCAP)*

So you wanna be a Cyberpunk? Or maybe just look like one?

Before you pitch off your sleepmat and jump in, there's a few things we need to tell you. First of all, the name. *Cyberpunk* comes from two words. *Cyber*—from the term cybernetic, or a fusion of flesh and machine technology. *Punk*—from an early 1980's rock music style that epitomized violence, rebellion and social action in a nihilistic way. The term was popularized in the Pre-Collapse days by a group of writers who specialized in writing science fiction with this kind of techno-melange. Their works featured a streamlined blend of rock, pop, sex, drugs and the highest, hippest technology—usually grafted onto your body somewhere. The archetypal cyberpunk heroes of the 80's ranged from technobarbarians roaming a Postholocaust world, to cyberchipped jet setters with designer bodies.

Of course, from our enlightened viewpoint here in 2020, this all looks pretty dated. After all, you probably accessed this article from your personal database 'comp. You used a Kiyoshiru 1300A interface cable with a direct link from your wristplugs. You're used to hard-wiring into the appliances to make coffee, "studding" into the 'Benz to drive down to the corner store. But understand—in 1987, this was all considered pretty visionary stuff. No one had plugs. You couldn't dial Luna on the cellular. Designer drugs were illegal. You could walk down most city streets without an armor jacket. There wasn't even a Net.

Now we know better. History books can tell you in detail about the Crash of 1994, when the Euro-Combines established the World Stock Exchange and the economies of the United States and Old Sov Russia collapsed.

In those days, both were ranked as superpowers, instead of a couple of overarmed second-raters waving nuclear weapons around under the watchful eye of the EuroSpace Defense Agency. As long as the Tycho massdrivers are ready to throw rocks at Moscow and Washington, we'll probably avoid having the nuclear war everyone's been expecting since 1944. After all, rocks are cheap.

Now, of course, everything's more or

less run by the Corporations, which are pretty much governments in themselves. You can go anywhere on one passport—one worldism at its best. The currencies of most nations are stabilized to each other, and the Eurodollar is a world currency. Hardly anyone complains anymore about Corporate Lifetime Contracts or the abolition of unions. It's the price of living in a stable, safe society, right?

After all, you *could* be living in the Projects. Sixteen people to an apartment, sharing ration chips every week to buy food, with eight thousand apartments per city block? Sure, it isn't the best life, what with the booster-gangs roaming the Malls and the major-league crime problems, but it beats actually being on the Street. At least the mega-arcologies have cops (okay, rented Corporate cops, but it's easier than fronting the euro for your own personal Solo!). Besides, the medians make sure that every apartment has direct cable access to TV, radio and sensory feed, so there's always something to do on a Saturday night.

Where were we? Oh yeah—you want to be a *Cyberpunk*.

Here's more background for you to think over. When the grand old Masters of the Movement first started writing the *cyberpunk* genre, they assumed that most of the things they wrote about would either never happen or would happen in the far future. No one knew that the West Germans were already developing "organic" circuitry in the late 1980's, or that the United States Air Force was developing mentally controlled weapons systems. Synthetic myomar muscle fibres were just starting to be used to control prosthetics, and very few people could project ahead into the 1990's when organic chipped arms and legs would be possible. There were a few primitive experiments with bioengineering—things like Frostban™ and a few new types of corn—nothing like the bio-engineered animals that we'll use to terraform the Martian colonies.

It took about fifteen years for the newtech to catch up with the vision. First, the military started using cyberotechnology to create "perfect soldiers" and pilots. Some of the spin-off led to prosthetic limbs, eyes and other body parts. Organic circuitry led to direct hookups between men and computers. Combined with advanced telecommunications technology and satellite downlinks, the basis for the now planetwide Net, was established. As each new technological advancement slammed into place, a sort of cultural technoshock set in.

1) Style over Substance

It doesn't matter how well you do something, as long as you look good doing it. If you're going to blow it, make sure you look like you planned it that way. Normally, clothes and looks don't matter in an adventure—in this world, having a leather armor jacket and mirrorshades is a serious consideration.

2) Attitude is Everything

It's truth. Think dangerous; be dangerous. Think weak; be weak. Remember, everyone in the 2000's is carrying lots of lethal hardware and high-tech enhancements. They won't be impressed by your new H&K smartgun unless you swagger into the club looking like you know how to use it—and are just itching for an excuse.

Never walk into a room when you can stride in. Never look at someone unless you can make it your best "killer" look. Use your best "I'm bad and you aren't." smile. Don't sit around the flat or cube waiting for the next job. Get on out and hit the clubs and hangouts. Make sure you're where the party starts.

3) Live on the Edge

The *Edge* is that nebulous zone where risk takers and highriders go. On the Edge, you'll risk your cash, your rep, even your life on something as vague as a principle or a big score. As a *cyberpunk*, you want to be the action, start the rebellion, light the fire. Join great causes and fight for big issues. Never drive slow when you can drive fast. Throw yourself up against danger and take it head on. Never play it too safe. Stay committed to the Edge.

ROLES: The Core of CYBERPUNK Role-playing

The world of *Cyberpunk* is a combination of savage, sophisticated, modern and retro-grade. Fashion-model beautiful Techies rub shoulders with battle armored road warriors, all of them making the scene in the hottest danceclubs, sleaziest bars and meanest streets

this side of the Postholocaust. Each character in this world is playing a **Role**—a face that person projects to the outside world as the real thing. There are 9 Roles in *Cyberpunk*: **Rockerboys, Solos, Netrunners, Corporates, Techies, Cops, Fixers, Medias, and Nomads.** As a *Cyberpunk* player, you must select one role for your character.

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Special Abilities are skills usable only by specific character Roles; for example, Rockerboys have the Special Ability of *Charismatic Leadership*, which represents the vast amount of power they have over their legions of fans. When using a Special Ability, you will add its value to the specific stat as if it were a skill.

Rockerboy Special Ability: Charismatic Leadership. This skill allows the Rocker to sway crowds equal to his ability level squared, times 200.

Solo Special Ability: Combat Sense. Added to all *Initiative* and

Awareness checks, this makes the Solo the fastest reacting person in a situation.

Netrunner Special Ability: Interface.

This Skill reflects the Netrunner's ability to manipulate Interface programs, and is the skill used when operating *Menu* functions such as *Locate Remote, Run Software, Control Remote, LDL Link, Load, Create* and *Delete*. Other players can enter the Net, but can't use the Menu.

Techie Special Ability: Jury Rig. This general repair skill allows the Techie to temporarily repair or alter anything for 1 D6 turns per level of skill.

Medtech Special Ability: Medical Tech. This is the skill used to perform major surgery and medical repairs.

Media Special Ability: Credibility. The ability to have people believe what you are saying while in your on-air persona.

THE RULES:
"1) Style Over Substance.
2) Attitude is Everything.
3) Always take it to the Edge.
4) Break the Rules."
—Ripperjack



Cop Special Ability: Authority. The ability to intimidate or control others through your position as a lawman.

Corporate Special Ability: Resources. This represents the Corporate's ability to command corporation resources. It is used as a persuasion skill, based on the scale of resources requested.

Fixer Special Ability: Streetdeal. The ability to locate people, information, etc. This is a higher form of *making a connection* (Lifepath, pg. 27); instead of knowing only one person, you have connections everywhere. In game play, a successful use of Streetdeal allows you to locate and acquire a desired person, place or thing.

Nomad Special Ability: Family. This allows the Nomad to call in as many Family members to aid him as his current *Family Ability* level x 2.

A SPECIAL NOTE ABOUT THIS PRINTING

Ahem! It's NOT a Third Edition. In this reprint, we've taken extra time to fix all the corrections and typos we could find, plus squared away a few of the problems and inconsistencies. But these rules are the same rules you've been using since the 2020 edition of the game was printed.

But there is **one big change**— the art. One of the great joys of publishing international editions is that sometimes your licensors come up with cool stuff you really wish *you'd* put into your game. The new art in this printing is from the great guys at *Stratelibri*, who publish the Italian *Cyberpunk* (many thanks to Paolo, Matteo, Riccardo, Angelo, Silvio and of course, Giovanni). We hope all of you out there like it as much as we did!

—Maximum Mike

Technoshock: When technology outstrips people's ability to comprehend or fit it into their lives. Suddenly, people freak out. They get irrational; violent. Families shatter; relationships tear apart. People feel helpless in the face of the Universe. Eventually, the whole society grinds to a halt, the victim of a mass psychosis. That's what we now call the Collapse.

There were three major responses to technoshock. The vast majority of people, their lives uprooted and changed by the advancements, sat passively waiting for their leaders to tell them what to do next. One smaller group tried to turn back the clock, founding the basis for what we call the Neo-Luddite movement. The remaining group—they decided to hit the future head on. With the old 1980's visionary writings as their guide, they established the movement we now call *Cyberpunk*.

Okay, so now you're ready.

As a *cyberpunk*, you grab technology by the throat and hang on. You're not afraid to check out the newest in "enhancements", cybertech and bio-engineering. You've got interface plugs in your wrists, weapons in your arms, lasers in your eyes, biochip programs in your brain. You become the car you drive, the gyro you fly, the guns you shoot. You dive headfirst into the Net, using your mind to hurtle at lightspeed all over a vast network of Data Fortresses and Artificial Intelligences. With cyborged fingers you pick computer locks; with enhanced senses, you see into the Future.

Cyberpunk is also an attitude. You wear the most "in" clothes, know the right people, and follow the right crowds. You plan your crimes in the most select clubs and bars; your enemies are Corporate armies, cyborg bike gangs, power-armored assassins and computer-wired Netheads. Your weapons are nerve, street-smarts, bravado and the Minami 10 smartgun on your hip.

Are you ready now? Of course you are. You can't wait.

Now you're *Cyberpunk*.

CYBERPUNKS

ROCKERBOYS

REBEL ROCKERS WHO USE MUSIC AND REVOLT TO FIGHT AUTHORITY

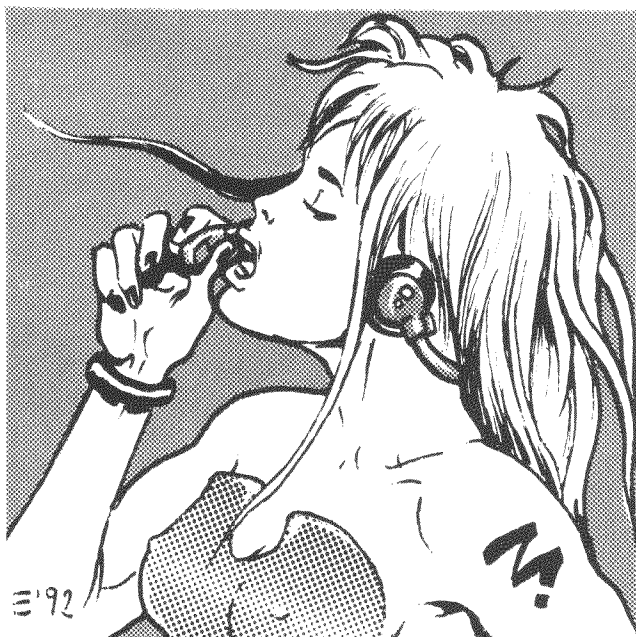
If you live to rock, this is where you belong. Rockerboys are the street poets, social consciences and rebels of the 2000's. With the advent of digital porta-studios and garage laser disk mastering, every Rocker with a message can take it to the street; put it in the record stores, bounce it off the comsats.

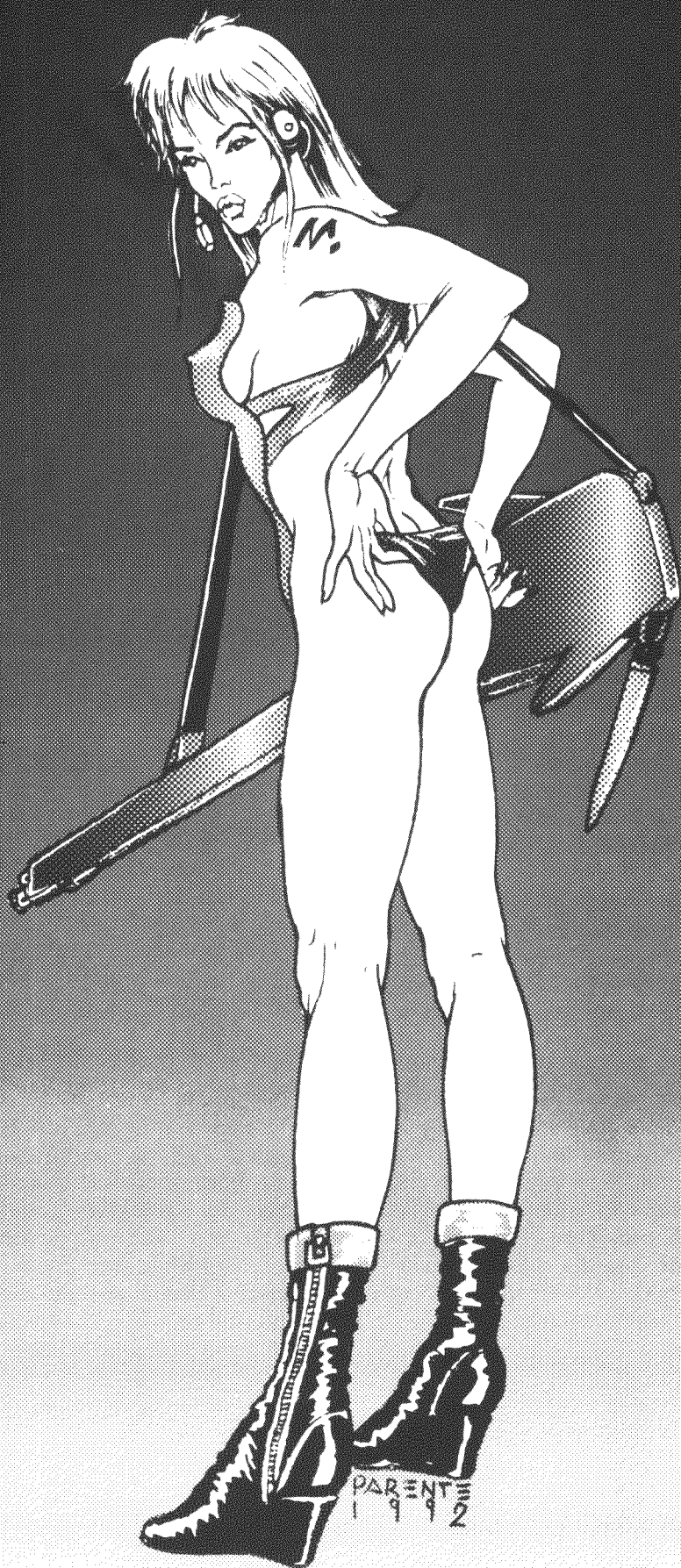
Sometimes, this message isn't something the Corporations or the Government wants to hear. Sometimes what you say is going to get right in the faces of the powerful people who really run this world. But you don't care, because as a Rockerboy, you know it's your

place to challenge authority, whether in straight-out protest songs that tell it like it is, or just by playing kick-ass rock n' roll to get the people away from the TV sets and into the Streets. You have a proud history as a Rockerboy—Dylan, Springsteen, Who, Elvis, the Stones—the legions of hardrock heroes who told the truth with screaming guitars and gut-honest lyrics.

As a Rockerboy, you have the power to get the people up—to lead, inspire and inform. A song from you can give the timid courage, the weak strength, and the blind vision.

Rockerboy legends have led armies against Corporations and Governments. Rockerboy songs have exposed corruption, brought down dictators. It's a lot of power for a guy doing gigs every night in another city. But you can handle it. After all—you came to play!





"I always knew what I had to do. It was really obvious. There were these scum out there who were messing with the world. They were killing people, raping the land, and lying in our faces when we caught 'em.

"So I decided I had to put the heat on 'em and make 'em sweat. That's why I became a Rockerboy.

"Music always gets hammered down to the Three A's. Axe, Attitude and Audience. Me, I had an Axe and an Attitude. All I had to do was get the third one..."

*—Kerry Eurodyne,
Rockerboy.*

CYBERPUNK

SOLOS

**HIRED ASSASSINS, BODYGUARDS, KILLERS,
SOLDIERS**

You were re-born with a gun in your hand—the flesh and blood hand, not the metallic weapons factory that covers most of your other arm. Whether as a freelance guard and killer-for-hire, or as one of the Corporate cybersoldiers that enforce business deals and the Company's "black operations", you're one of the elite fighting machines of the *Cyberpunk* world.

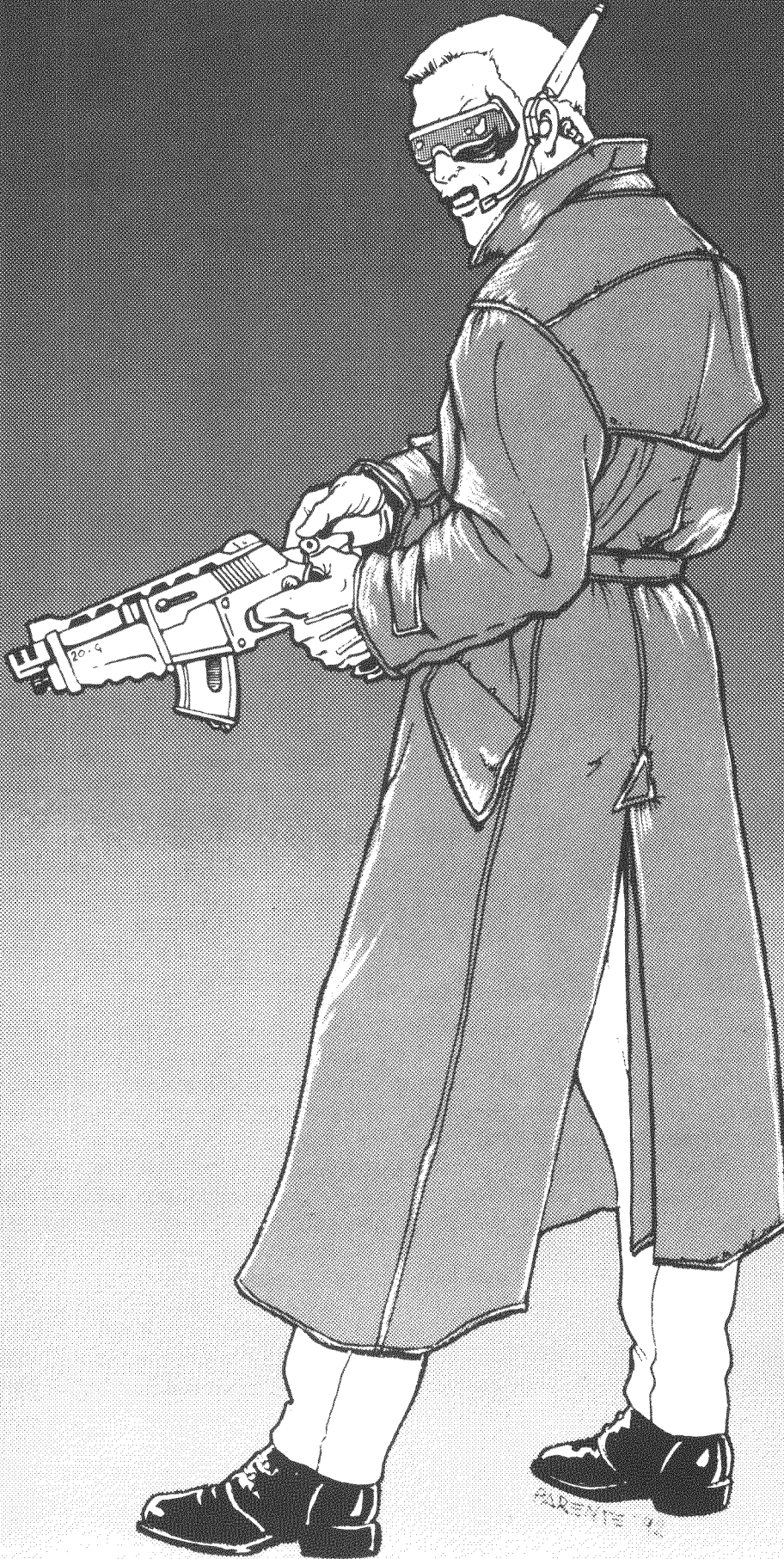
Most Solos have put in military time, either in a Corporate army or in one of the Government's continual "police actions" around the world. As the battle damage piles up, you start to rely more and more upon hardware—cyberlimbs for weapons and armor, bio-program chips to increase your reflexes and awareness, combat drugs to give you that edge over your opponents. When you're the best of the best, you might even leave the ranks of Corporate samurai and go *ronin*—freelancing your lethal talents as killer, bodyguard or enforcer to whoever can pay your very high fees.

Sounds good? There's a price—a heavy one. You've lost so much of your original meat



body that you're almost a machine. Your killing reflexes are so jacked up that you have to restrain yourself from going beserk at any moment. Years of combat drugs taken to keep the edge have given you terrifying addictions. You can't trust anyone—your mother, your friends, your lovers—no one. One night you sleep in a penthouse condo in the City—the next in a filthy alley on the Street. But that's the price of being the best.

And you're willing to pay it. Because you're a Solo.



"After I got out of the Army, I had this problem. I was good at what I did, but no one was hiring. I mean, what do you do when you're a highly trained killer with a background in demolitions? Read the want ads?"

"After a few months on the Street, I got into a dustdown with a local Booster lord. I flatlined him and went back to my drink. Within ten minutes, the recruiter from Milltech came up to me and dropped a business card..."

"Now I'm a Company man. The pay's good, the Work steady, and they pay for my spare parts. So far, I'm still alive."

So far, so good."

—Morgan Blackhand

CYBERPUNKS

NETRUNNERS

CYBERNETIC COMPUTER HACKERS

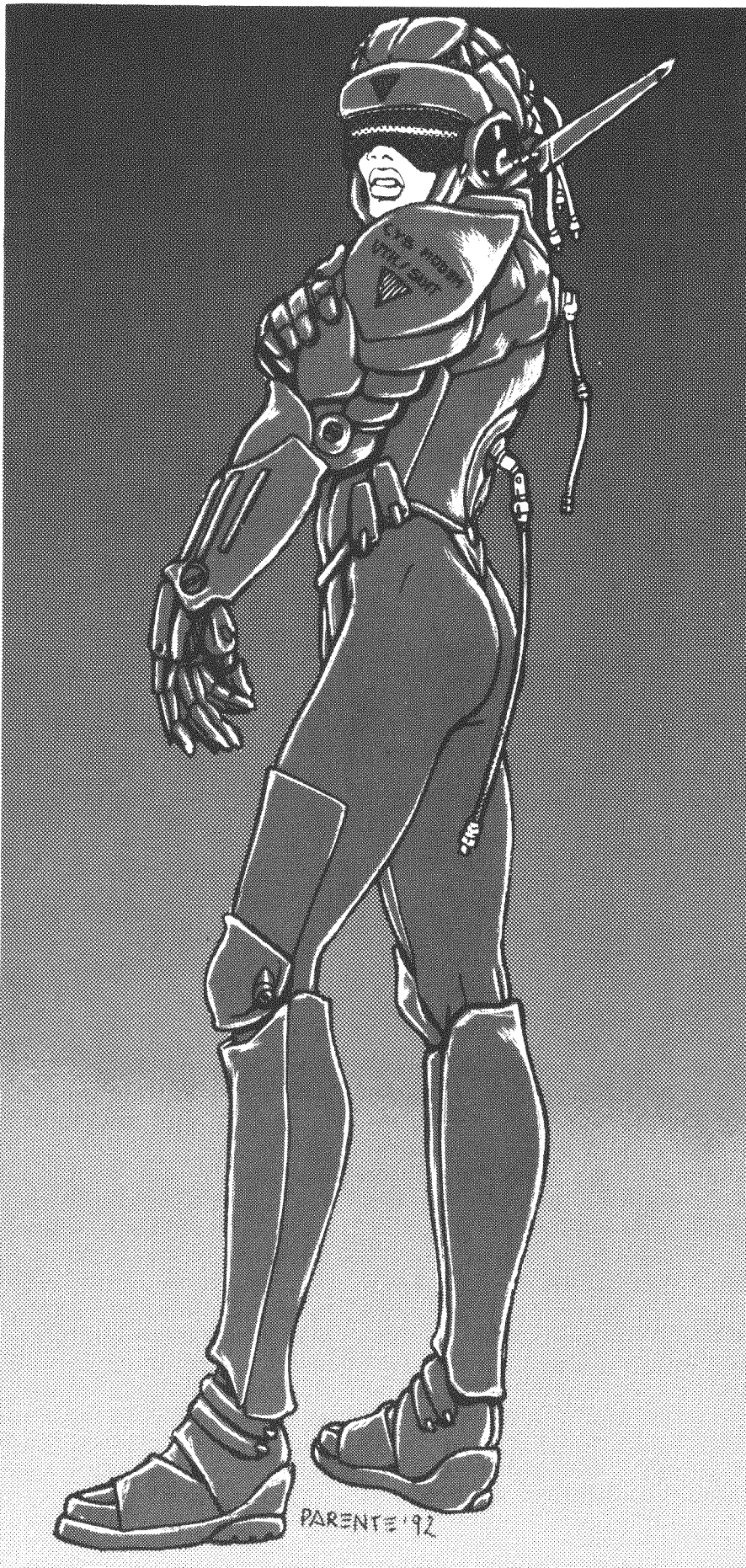


At three, your parents bought you an old Apple IV GS with a Radius 241 wall screen, and your life was changed. By fifth grade, you'd already mastered everything the school computer literacy lab could throw at you—you were already using C and META-LINGUA to crack into the district's mainframe and change your grades. When you were thirteen, you shifted enough funds out of unprotected TransAmerican Bank accounts to finance your first neural interface plugs.

Now, nothing can stop you. With your direct mental link to the computer, you can plunge

headfirst into the dizzying data-winds of the Net; the worldwide telecommunications system that joins humanity together. As an electronic wraith, you are the ultimate "hacker", your brain wired into special modems and computer links. You slip into the "hardest" mainframe systems with ease. Your defense and offense programs are arrayed at a touch of your mental fingertips—a quick jolt of Demon or Vampire and the data fortresses fall. EBM. ITT. Sony-Matsushita-Ford. You've tackled them all, buying, trading and selling their deepest secrets at will.

Sometimes you uncover important things—Corporate treachery or deadly secrets. But that's not why you Netrun. You live for the new program, the next satellite downlink—the next piece of hot data that comes your way. It's only a matter of time, you think—every year, the counter intrusion programs get better, the Artificial Intelligences smarter. Sooner or later, a faster program or programmer's going to catch up; reach out with electronic fingers through your interface plugs, and stop your heart. But time's on your side, and until the ride runs out, you'll be there, barebrained and headfirst in the Net.



"You guys who live in Realspace; you move so slow. Me, I like Netspace. It moves fast. You don't get old, you don't get slow and sloppy. You just leave the meat behind and go screamin'.

"First system I ever hit, I think they had some weeflerunner playin' Sysop for them. I burned in, jolted the guy with a borrowed Hellbolt, and did the major plunder action all over the Data Fortress.

"Somewhere out there is a guy with half his forebrain burned out. I wonder if they ever found the body. I wonder if they'll find mine the same way..."

—Spider Murphy

CYBERPUNKS

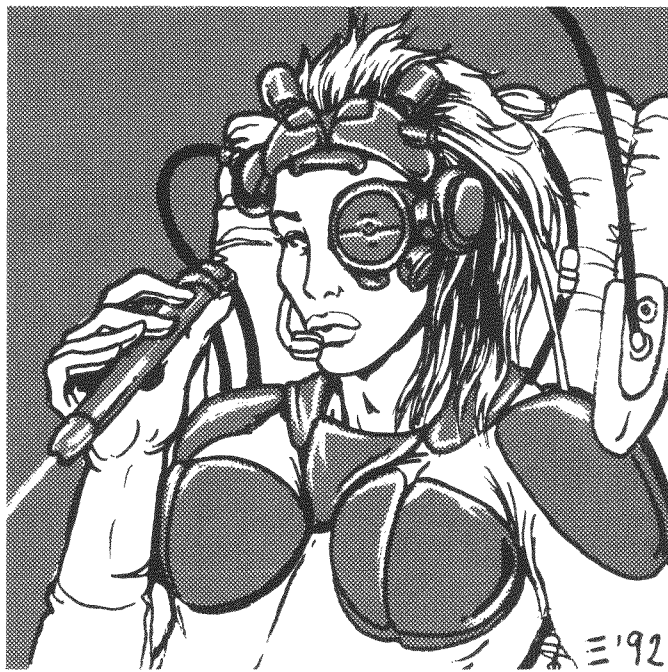
TECHIES

RENEGADE MECHANICS AND DOCTORS

You can't leave anything alone—if it sits near you for more than five minutes, you've disassembled it and made it into something new. You've always got at least two screwdrivers and a wrench in your pockets. Computer down? No problem. Hydrogen burner out in your Metrocar? No problem. Can't get the video to run or your interface plugs feedbacking? No problem.

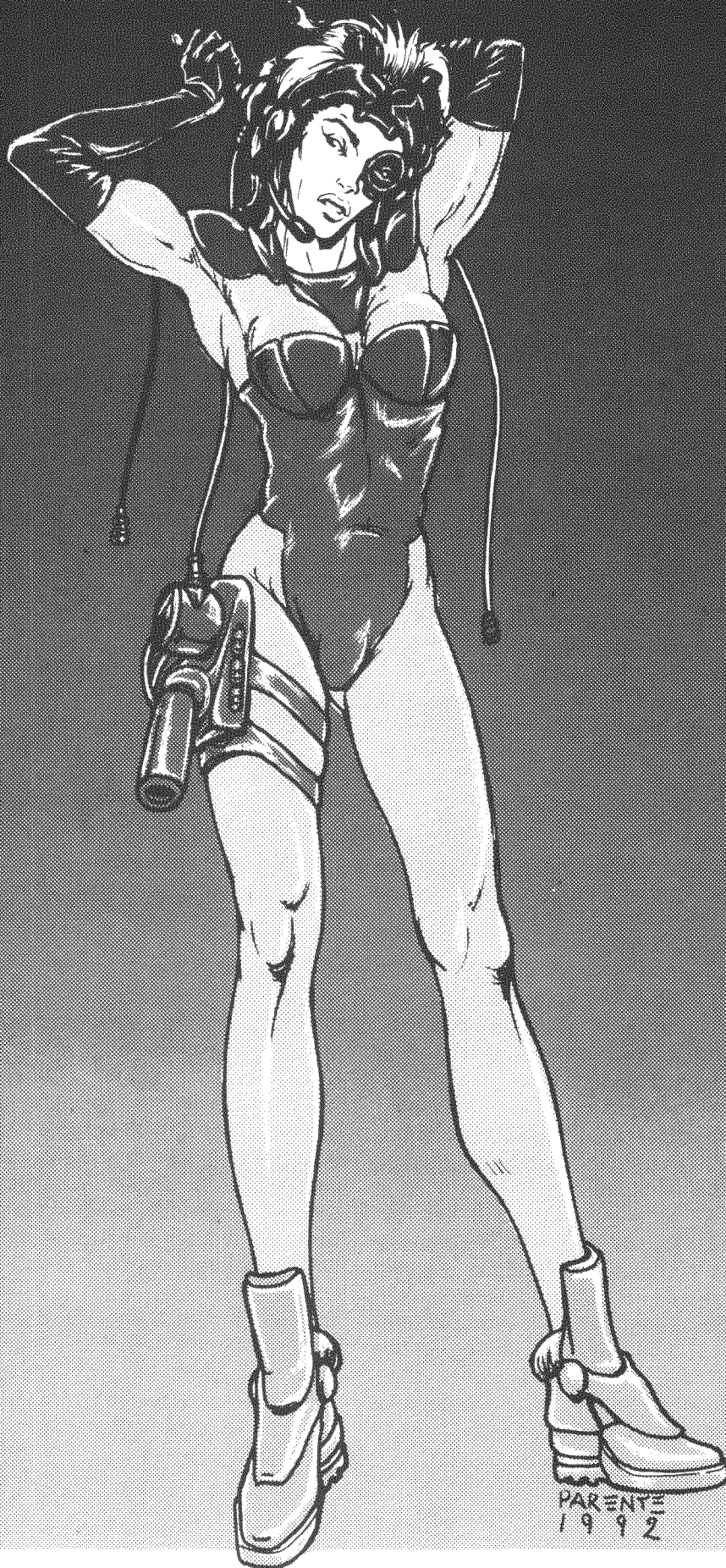
You make your living building, fixing and modifying—a crucial occupation in a technological world where no one person really knows how half the stuff works. You can make some good bucks fixing everyday stuff, but for the serious money, you need to tackle the big jobs. Illegal weapons. Illegal or stolen cybertech. Corporate espionage and counterespionage gear for the big boys' "black operations". Neat little gadgets like thermite bombs and and hunter-killer robots for the occasional "termination."

If you're any good, you're making a lot of money. And that money goes into new gadgets, hardware and information. You'll buy almost any new thing—because it might have a dozen side applications you can use. Of course, your black market work isn't just making you friends—it's also racking you up an impressive number of enemies as well; people who've run into



your handiwork and resented it. So you'll invest a lot in defense systems and, if really pushed to the wall, call in a few markers on a Solo or two.

Your cousin down the street is just like you, but he's a **Medtechie**. In a world where half of medicine is related to mechanics, it makes sense. He can do a black market surgical technique faster than you can fix a toaster, and the Solos are always running to him to patch up wounds or install new illegal cybernetics. He's got a lot of the same problems you have, but he's hoping his new job with Trauma Team Inc.™ will loosen things up. You hope he's right. You may be needing his services sooner than you think.



"So you want me to build a delay switch into the thing? And you don't care about the explosion radius?"

"No problem. At least you got a simple job. Last guy in here, he wanted me to build him a cyberhand that had a built-in ...aw, frack, you don't wanna know. People want the weirdest stuff these days..."

"I hear with the new cyberwear they're coming up with in Chiba, you're gonna be able to cram your body with more options than a frackin' Mercedes aerodyne...No problem. If you can get parts, I can fix it. Count on it, chombatta."

**—Mister Ice
Head of Design
Technix, Inc.**

CYBERPUNKS

MEDIAS

NEWSMEN AND REPORTERS WHO GO TO THE WALL FOR THE TRUTH

They're bending the truth out there. And you're going to stop them. Someone has to do it. The Corporations rule the world. They dump toxics, destabilize economies and commit murder with equal impunity. The Government won't stop them—they own the Government. The only thing between the Corporations and world domination is the Media. And that's you.

You've got a videocam and a press pass—and you're not afraid to use them. You're a national figure, seen nightly on a million TV sets worldwide. You've got fans, contracts and your own Corporation backing you. They can't make you disappear. When you dig down for the dirt and slime the corrupt officials and Corporate lapdogs try to cover up, you can dig deep. The next morning, you can put the details of their crimes all over the screamsheets and vidscreens. Then the Government has to act.

A week ago, you followed a hot lead and discovered a medical corporation dumping illegal drugs on the Street. This week, you're uncovering a secret Corporate war in South America—a war with jets, bombs, and cybertroops that's killed almost seven thousand innocent people. Each new story you get to the air is one more blow for freedom and justice. Not to mention ratings.

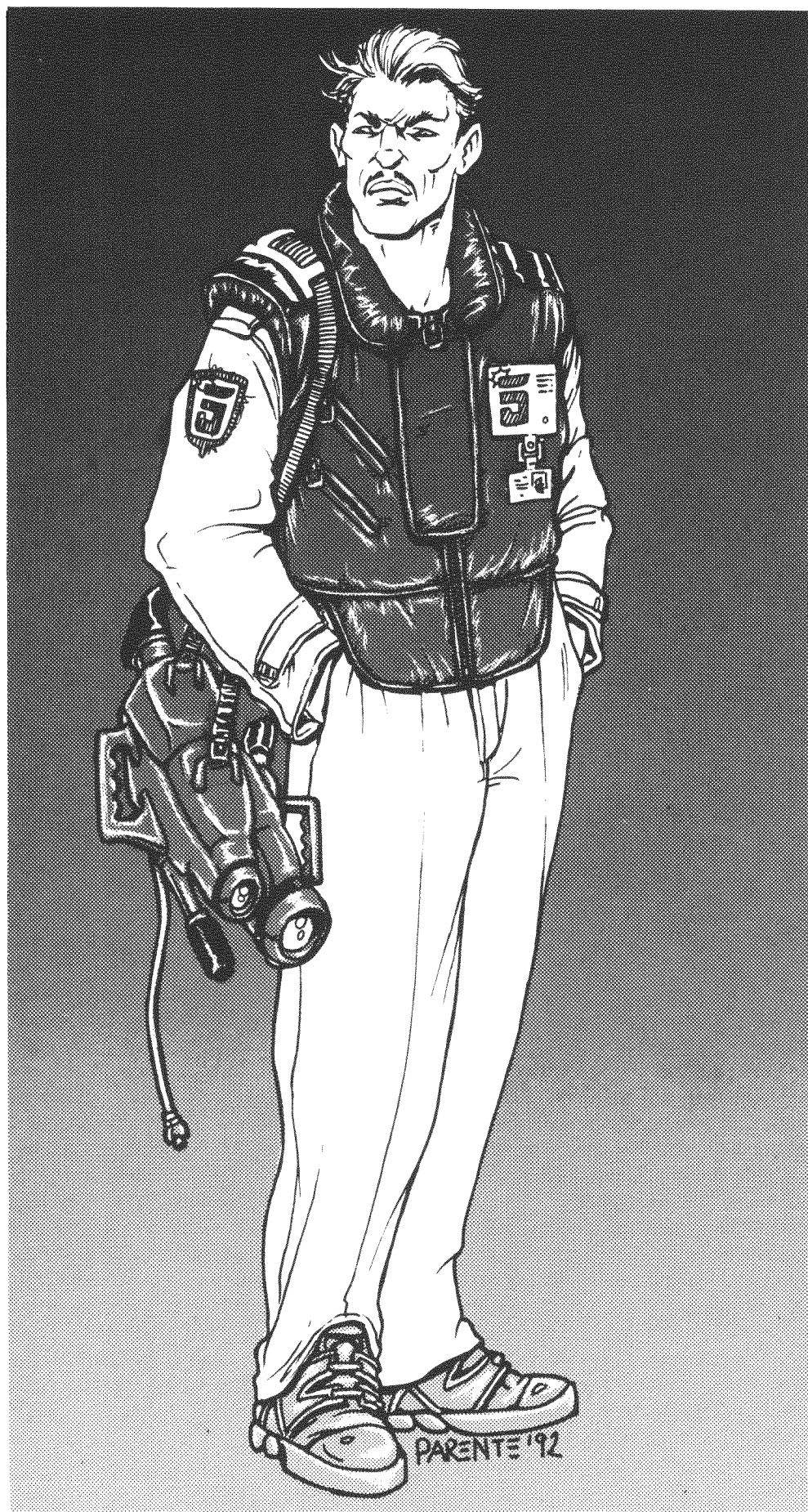
It isn't easy. They've tried to pressure your



Mediacorp dozens of times. You've had stories suppressed—once, Corporate pressure forced them to cancel your news show. Each time, you went to the top, backed by your news director and your crew, and fought to get the story out. Three or four times, they tried to kill you—that's why your backup's a crack Solo bodyguard and you've got one of the top 'Runners in the business digging through the Net to back your stories. You have to be good, or else.

Your 'Runner's just phoned in with a hot lead. He's found a line on twenty tons of illegal weapons being shifted to a port in Bolivia—possibly nuclear. You grab your gear and flag your backup. You're going to break those bastards.

This time, for sure.



"Okay, so it's dangerous. Look, I'll tell you something. When I was a kid, I used to watch those reporters on the TV news. They wore those chill trenchcoats and were always broadcasting from some exotic place like Mozambique or Salgon. They went right into the Central American warzones with the cybergrunts, and they got the story even when the shooting was maximally fierce."

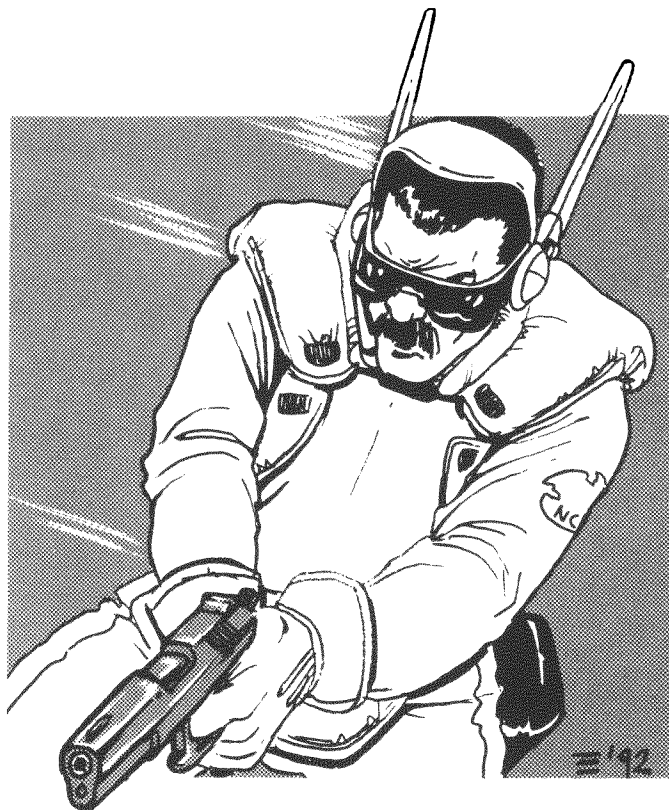
"That's the part I like; the danger."

—Lyle McClellan,
Network 54

CYBERPUNKS

COPS

MAXIMUM LAWMEN ON MEAN 21ST CENTURY STREETS



armored squadcar, patrolling this jungle with the heavy predators.

The Corporate Cops—now that's the life. Heavy weapons, full combat armor, Trauma Team™ backup, AV-4 assault vehicles and gyrocopters with miniguns. But they only patrol the sectors of the City that the Government's licensed them for. The nice, clean sectors full of new office buildings and fancy restaurants—where no jacked up psychopunk is going to ever go on a killing spree with an AK-47. You get the bad sections. Burned out buildings and abandoned

cars, where every night is a new firefight and another great opportunity for a messy death.

If you're really unlucky, you might draw PsychoSquad detail. PsychoSquad guys get the job of hunting down heavily armed and armored cyborgs who've flipped out. Sure, the PS guys have access to railguns, gyros and AVs. But a cyberpsycho can walk through machine gun fire and not feel it. A lot of the Psycho Squad detectives are crazy themselves. They load up with boosted reflexes, get some monstrously huge guns, and go hunt the cyborgs solo. But you're not that crazy.

Yet.

In the old days, they only used to shoot at cops. Now you're lucky if you just take a slug. The Street is mean these days, filled with new drugs, new gangs, and new weapons that make an M-16 look like a kid's toy. If you're on a City Force, you know how bad it is. You're carrying at least four high caliber weapons, most of them full-auto types, wearing a Kevlar vest that'll stop 850 ft/lbs per square inch—and you're still outgunned and outflanked. Half the gangs are cyber to begin with—super speed, super reflexes, can see in the dark, carry weapons in their arms...The other half are freelance Corporate mercs—gangs hired by the Corps to enforce their policies on the Street. And there you are—a beat cop or detective in an



"Drop it, punk. I don't wanna hear your life story, and I don't care what Society did to you. I just wanna see that gun hit the floor. Now..."

—Before I give you an extra nostril.."

***—Sgt. Max Hammerman
NCPD***

CYBERPUNKS

CORPORATES

SLICK BUSINESS RAIDERS AND MULTI-MILLIONAIRES

In the old days, they would have called you a yuppie—a hard driven, fast-track MBA on his way up the Corporate ladder. Sure, it's selling your soul to the Company, but face it; the Corporations rule the Cyberpunk world. They control governments, markets, nations, armies—you name it. And you know that whoever controls the Corporations controls everything else.

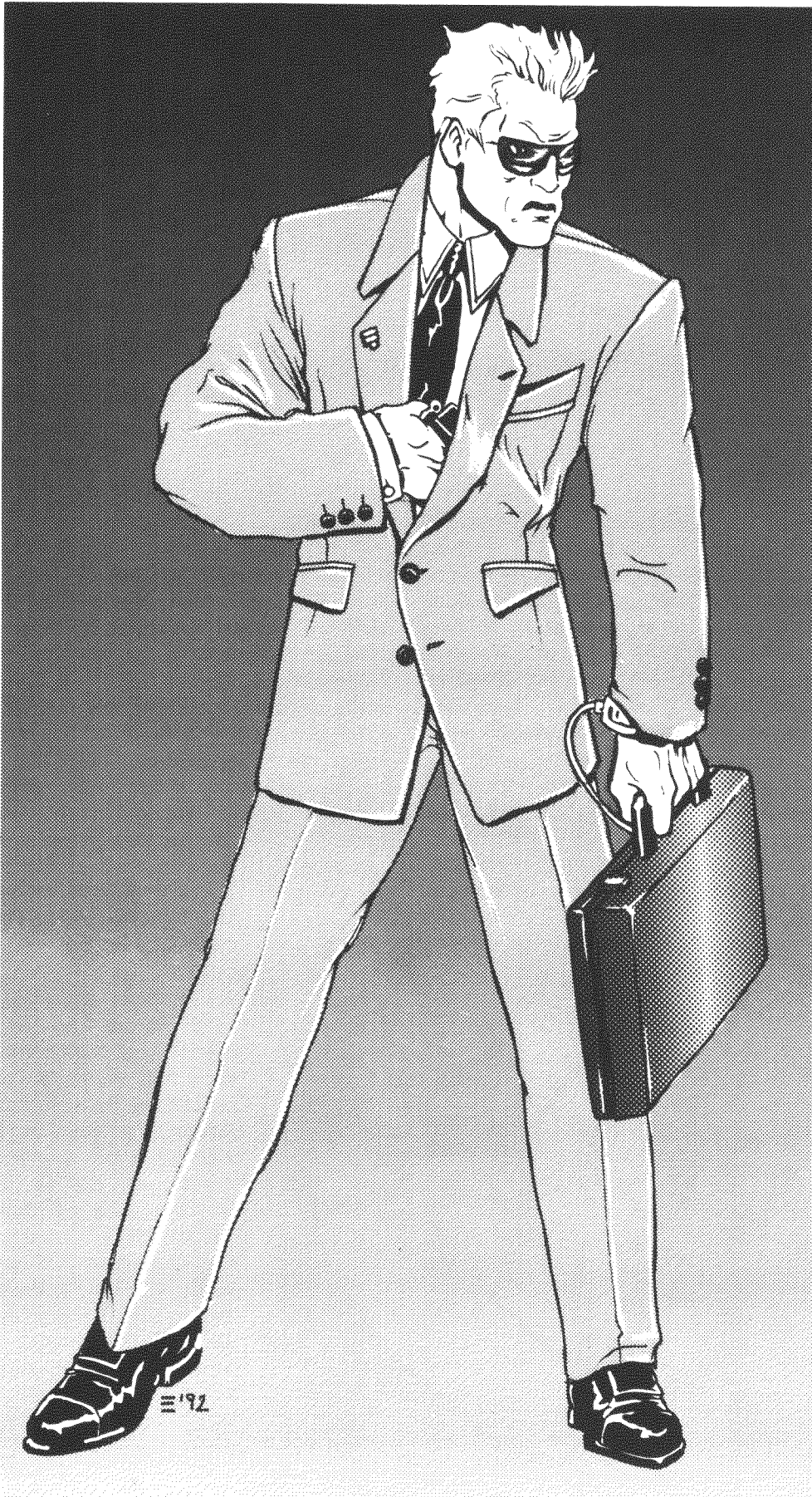
Right now, your life as a junior executive is anything but easy. There are guys underneath you who'd kill for a shot at your job. There are guys over you who'd kill to keep you out of their jobs. And they're not kidding about the killing—every up and comer in the Corporation has his own crew of Solos and Netrunners to cover his pet projects. Sabotage? Constantly. Bribery? Routine. Black-mail? Common. Promotion by assassination? Always a possibility. The stakes are that high—one slip and you could be out on the Street with the rest of the trash. Or dead.

And the projects your supervisors give you! Some are pretty straightforward; design a new productivity schedule for the Corporation's medical subsidiary. Some are pretty raw—send a "black operations" team into the City to spread a designer plague so the Marketing team can clean up selling the vaccine. Last week, you led a mixed team of



Solos, 'Runners and Techies on a headhunting run to kidnap a researcher from a rival company. The week before, your project was to steal plans for a new suborbital shuttle from the EuroSpace Agency (so that the Aerospace Division could copy the design and sell it to the Soviets).

You told yourself you joined the Corporation to make it a better place—work from the inside, you said. But now you're not so sure. Your ideals are a little tarnished and things are getting pretty bleak. But you can't worry about ethics now. You've got a report due in an hour, and it looks like that guy in Sales is planning to ice your database for good. You're gonna ice him first.



"Money. Yeah, I got money: a new BMW aerodyne, and a penthouse flat in the Corporate Zone. All the money ain't worth frack. You play this game for power. The power to get things done; to make the big decisions; to affect things. You make a phone call, and the next thing you know, you're telling the president of some bushleague Euronation that he'd better play it your way, or he's history.

"That's why you play. That's why I'm with the Company."

—An Unidentified Corporate

CYBERPUNKS

FIXERS

**DEAL MAKERS, SMUGGLERS, ORGANIZERS
AND INFORMATION BROKERS**

You realized fast that you weren't ever going to get into a Corporate job. And you didn't think you were tough enough or crazy enough to be a Solo either. But as a small time punk, you knew you had a knack for figuring out what other people wanted, and how to get it for them. For a price, of course.

Now your deals have moved past the nickle-and-dime stuff into the big time. Maybe you move illegal weapons over the border. Or steal and resell medical supplies from the Corporations. Perhaps you're a skill broker—

acting as an agent for high priced Solos and 'Runners, or even hiring a whole Nomad pack to back a client's contracts. You buy and sell favors like an old-style Mafia godfather. You have connections into all kinds of businesses, deals and political groups. You don't do this directly, of course—no, you use your contacts and allies as part of a vast web of intrigue and coercion. If there's a hot nightclub in the City, you've bought into it. If there are new military-class weapons on the Street, you smuggled 'em in. If there's a Corporate war going down, you're negotiating between sides with an eye on the main chance.



But you're not entirely in it for the bucks. If someone needs to get the heat off, you'll hide them. You get people housing when there isn't any, and you bring in food when the neighborhoods are blockaded. Maybe you do it because you know they'll owe you later, but you're not sure. You're one part Robin Hood and two parts Al Capone. Back in the 90's, they would have called you a *crimelord*. But this is the fragmented, nasty, deadly 2020s. Now they call you a Fixer.



"Don't glve me this "Robin Hood" stuff. I'm doin' a job, no more. I glve people what they want, an' they pay me out.

"Okay, so maybe I even a few scores here and there, but that's good for business. You make a friend—they'll take you in when the Street's too hot, and they'll pass you a few blts of data when you call in the markers. But that's business.

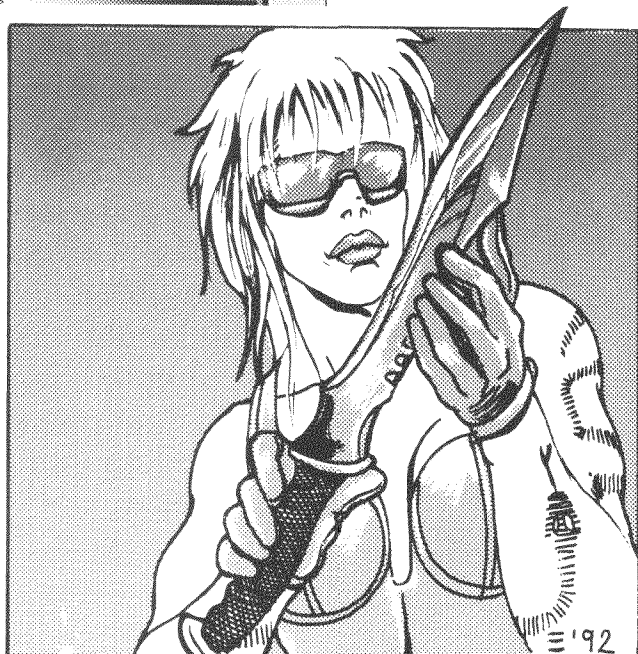
*"I got a slogan...
"How much you pay me?"*

—Phil "Nacho"
Hernandez
Fixer

PACKS

NOMADS

ROAD WARRIORS AND GYPSIES WHO ROAM THE HIGHWAYS



They drove your family off the Farm ten years ago. The Corporations rolled in, took over the land, and put rent-a-cops all over the place. It wasn't the first time it'd happened; it wouldn't be

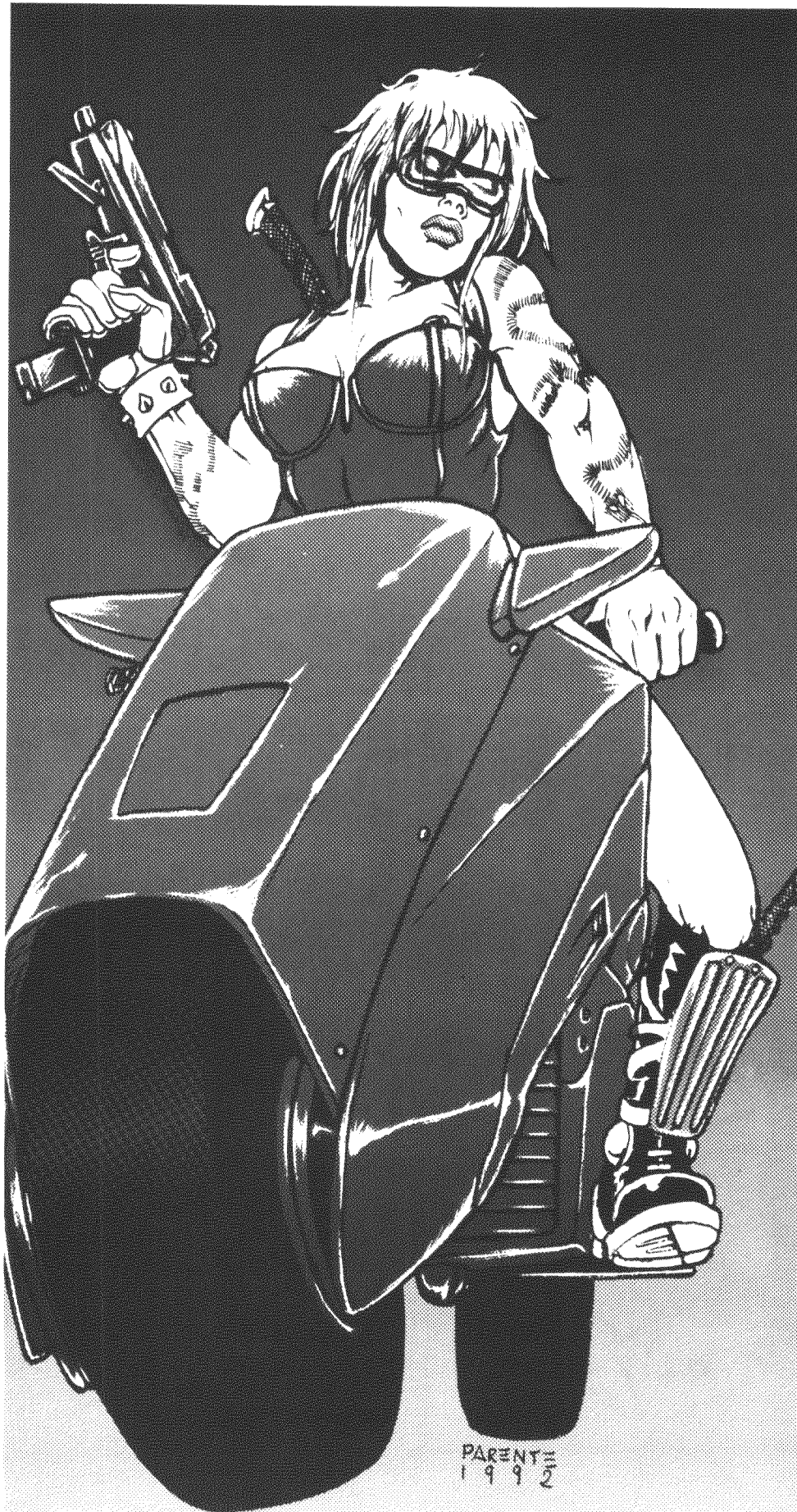
and mechanics—it's virtually a town on wheels in which everyone is related by marriage or kinship. Sometimes the Pack pulls into a town just to fuel up or get grub. Other times, it swings south to follow the harvest; you pick crops in trade for cash or food. Less law abiding Packs are like mobile armies, terrorizing cities and hiring out as muscle in Corporate wars. For obvious reasons, the cops don't like Nomads. But it doesn't matter—your vehicles are usually well armored and bristling with stolen weapons; mini guns, rocket launchers and the like. Every kid knows how to use a rifle, and everyone packs a knife. Being homeless in the 2000's isn't easy.

the last. Gradually, your family fell in with a bunch of other homeless families, and they met another group...until you'd created a Nomad pack of nearly two hundred members.

Now, crammed into a huge, ragtag fleet of cars, vans, buses and RV's, your Nomad pack roams the freeways. You look for supplies, odd jobs and spare parts in a world where society has fragmented. The pack is your home—it has teachers, Med Techs, leaders,

The most visible members of the Pack are the Scouts—leather armored riders on bikes or in fast muscle cars, who protect the convoy from attacks and hunt up safe campsites. As a Scout, you're on the lookout for trouble, and you usually can find enough of it, with rival Nomad Packs, the Law, and the Corporates all after you. Like a modern day cowboy, you ride the hard trail. You've got a gun, a bike and that's all you need. You're a Nomad.

CYBER



"Guns. Guns and cyberbikes. That's how we hold the line. We don't have any home except the Caravan. We don't have any rights except what we take. We get run out of town by the cops; we get raided by the roadwarrior packs, and we survive because we've got guns and bikes..."

"There's kids, old men and women—families here. This ain't no boostergang. These people are my family."

—Nomad Santiago

ROLES
CHARACTERS
LIFEPATH
TASK & SKILLS
WEAPONS
ARMOR
GEAR
CYBERWEAR
COMBAT
MEDICAL
NETRUNNING



"They were roaring in at top speed when they hit us. There must have been a hundred of them. We were pinned down and about to be turned into Ground Food Concentrate Number Fifteen. Then Razorjack popped the BigRipps, screamed like a banshee on steroids, and went right over the top of the lead cyberbike."

—Savage Doc

SECTION

2 GETTING CYBERPUNK

Headware is the hardware—the frame which allows the character to interface with the rules. Remember, the disk is not the software, and dice rolls are not your character. Don't get too caught up in the statistics.

Character Points

Character points are the cash of character creation—you use them to “buy” the various “mechanics” aspects of the character, like good looks, a strong, hard body, unshakable cool and street smarts (but not Skills). We've given you three ways to generate Character Points:

Headware: The stuff you need to make a Cyberpunk persona interface with the Rules of the Game.

1) Random:

Roll 9 D10 and total them. You have this many Character Points.

2) Fast: Roll 1 D10 for each stat (9 in all), re-rolling any scores of 2 or less. Place rolls in each stat as desired.

3) Cinematic: This option is for Referees only. As the designer of the adventure, the Referee has the option of choosing the number of points for each character based on its position in his or her game.

Major Hero	80pts
Major Supporting Char.	70pts
Minor Hero	75pts
Minor Supporting Char.	60pts
Average	50pts

Note: We could, at this point, warn prospective Referees about the various dodges their players will have for creating “supercharacters.” But face it; if they want to create a mondo character, who are we to stop them? You're all big boys and girls now, and if you, as Referee, think your players are getting way outa line, why not just go ahead and waste 'em?

That's the Cyberpunk way.

Dice

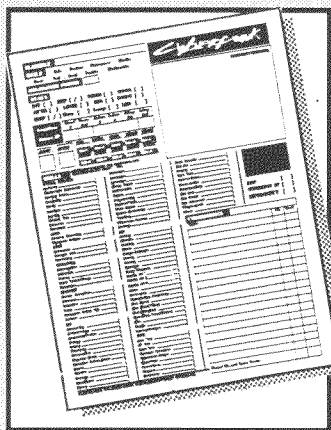
All systems in Cyberpunk use two types of dice; the common, garden variety six sided die (found in most popular games and in Las Vegas), and the more esoteric ten sided die (used exclusively by the Japanese Imperial Navy and in many roleplaying games). Dice are usually referred to in Cyberpunk as a “D”, followed by the number of sides of the dice. For example, a normal 6 sided die would be referred to as a “D6”. There are a number of ways in which dice can be used, such as:

- Rolling a group of dice together and adding the results (roll 3D6 would mean roll 3 six sided dice to get a value from 3 to 18).

- Rolling one or more dice together and adding another value called a modifier to get a final value, expressed as 1D6+1, or 1D10 -2.

- Rolling two ten sided dice together, designating one to mark the tens place and the other to mark the ones place (called rolling a percentage).

Rounding and Modifying: In Cyberpunk, if you are asked to divide something and you come up with a decimal value, you will automatically round the result down to the nearest whole number (such as 2.65352 becoming 2). If a modified value (such as 1D6-4) comes out equal to, or below zero, it is automatically equal to 1 unless otherwise specified.

THE HARDCOPY
FORM

First thing you're going to need is a place to record all of your information. Photocopy (or draw) your own Hardcopy Form to work on. Make sure you keep a backup of this form, just in case the original gets fragged in the middle of a run.

REMEMBER: THE FUTURE IS DISPOSABLE.

Okay, get out your Hardcopy, roll your dice, and let's start plugging in your character.

Statistics

Each *Cyberpunk* character has nine Statistics—values representing the level of native ability of the character in specific areas of activity. These Stats are rated from two to ten, with two being the worst possible, ten being the best possible, and the average falling at about five or six. Divide your total number of Character Points between each of your nine Stats, adjusting the amounts in each one as you think best describes the character's natural abilities. No Statistic may be less than two or greater than ten.

Intelligence (INT):

This is a measure of your problem solving ability; figuring out problems, noticing things, remembering information. Almost every character type will need a high Intelligence, with Netrunners and Corporates requiring the highest of all.

Reflexes (REF):

This is a combined index, covering not only your basic dexterity, but also how your level of physical coordination will affect feats of driving, piloting, fighting and athletics. Characters who intend to engage in a great deal of combat (such as Solos, Nomads or Rockerboys) should always invest in the highest possible Reflex.

Cool (CL):

This index measures how well the character stands up to stress, fear, pressure, physical pain and/or torture. In determining your willingness to fight on despite wounds or your fighting ability under fire, Cool (CL) is essential. It is also the measure of how "together" your character is and how tough he appears to others. Rockerboys and Fixers should always have a high Cool, with Solos and Nomads having the highest of all.

Technical Ability (TECH):

This is an index of how well you relate to hardware and other technically oriented things. In *Cyberpunk*, the ability to use and repair technology is of paramount importance—TECH will be the Stat used when fixing, repairing and attempting to use unfamiliar tech. While all characters should

have a decent Tech Stat, potential Techies should always opt for the highest possible score in this area.

Luck (LK):

This is the intangible "something" that throws the balance of events into your favor. Your luck represents how many points you may use each game to influence the outcome of a critical event. To use Luck, you may add any or all of the points of luck a character has to a critical die roll (declaring your intention to use Luck before the roll is made) until all of your Luck stat is used up. Luck is always restored at the end of each game session.

Attractiveness (ATT):

This is how good-looking you are. In *Cyberpunk*, it's not enough to be good—you have to look good while you're doing it (Attitude is Everything). Attractiveness is especially important to Medias and Rockerboys, as being good-looking is part of their jobs.

Movement Allowance (MA):

This is an index of how fast your character can run (important in combat situations). The higher your Movement Allowance (MA), the more distance you can cover in a turn.

RUN: To determine how far your character can run in a single combat round (@3.2 seconds) in meters, multiply your MA by 3. The character can run three times this distance in a full 10 second turn. Write this in the RUN section of your Hardcopy Form.

LEAP: To determine how far your character can leap (from a running start), divide your RUN by 4. Write this in the LEAP section of your Hardcopy Form.

Empathy:

This Stat represents how well you relate to other living things—a measure of charisma and sympathetic emotions. In a world of alienated, future-shocked survivors, the ability to be "human" can no longer be taken for granted. Empathy (EM) is critical

LIFEPATH, GEAR & WEAPONS

LIFEPATH

Style

Clothes

Hair

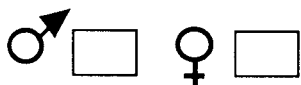
Affectations

Ethnicity

Language

Family Background

Siblings



Motivations

Traits

Valued Person

Value Most

Feel About People

Valued Possession

Life Events

One event for each year after age 16

YEAR

GEAR

[illegible]

WEAPONS

[illegible]

when leading, convincing, seducing or perceiving emotional undercurrents. Empathy is also a measure of how close he/she is to the line between feeling human being and cold blooded cyber-monster (see pg. 73 for details).

Humanity : This is a measure of the toll cybernetics takes on your ability to relate to other living things. Multiply your EMP by 10 to determine how many humanity points you have. Write the result in the box on your Hardcopy Form. Remember: for every 10 points of Humanity lost, you will automatically lose 1 point of EMP. This can have a serious effect on any Empathy-related Skills, as well as forcing you to the edge of cybernetic-induced psychosis.

Body Type (BT)

Strength, Endurance and Constitution are all based on the character's Body Type. Body Type determines how much damage you can take in wounds, how much you can lift or carry, how far you can throw (pg. 99), how well you recover from shock, and how much additional damage you cause with physical attacks. Body Type is important to all character types, but to Solos, Rockerboys and Nomads most of all.

BODY TYPES & POINTS

2 pts	Very Weak
3-4 pts	Weak
5-7 pts	Average
8-9 pts	Strong
10 pts	Very Strong

You may carry up to 10x your Body Type in kg. You may also dead lift 40 times your Body Type in kg.

Save Number

Your character's **Save Number** is a value equal to your Body Type. To make saves, you must roll a value on 1D10 equal to or lower than this number. There are two types of saves in *Cyberpunk*:

Stun Saves: When you take damage in *Cyberpunk*, or have been exposed to

knockout drugs, you will be required to make a **Stun Save**. If you fail a Stun Save, you will automatically be knocked out of combat and be unable to recover until you can make a *successful* Stun Save in a following combat turn. You may make one Save roll every turn until you succeed.

**"Dead is Dead.
Parts is Parts. Dead
guys is Parts."**

—Ripperjack

Death Saves: When you have been Mortally Wounded (see *Friday Night Firefight*, pg. 104), or when you have encountered certain types of

poisons, you will need to make a Save against **Death**. On a failed roll, you're Body Bank fodder.

Take a moment to find the Save box on your Hardcopy Form and fill it in.

Body Type Modifier (BTM)

Not all people take damage the same way. For example, it takes a lot more damage to stop Arnold The Terminator than it does Arnold the Nerd. This is reflected by the **Body Type Modifier**, a special bonus used by your character to reduce the effects of damage. The Body type modifier is subtracted from any damage your character takes in combat.

BODY TYPE MODIFIER TABLE

Very Weak	-0
Weak	-1
Average	-2
Strong	-3
Very Strong	-4
Superhuman*	-5

*Possible only with cybernetics

For example, say you took ten points of damage. If you were a Very Weak Body Type, you would take the full ten. But with a Very Strong Body Type, you'd only take $(10-4=6)$ six points of damage.

Find the Body Type Modifier (BTM) box on your Hardcopy Form and fill it in. Remember; no matter how cybered up you get, make sure you're solid meat underneath.

**"Attention,
Bodybankers!
We've got a
Blue Light
Special going
on right now in
Cryochamber
Number
Fifteen! We've
got eyes in all
colors and
conditions,
going for half
price! Hurry on
down to
Chamber
Fifteen for best
selection, and
get 'em before
they spoil..."**

—Medicross
Preservation

MASTER SKILL LIST

SPECIAL ABILITIES

Authority (Cop)
 Combat Sense (Solo)
 Charis. Leadersh p (Rockers)
 Credibility (Media)
 Family (Nomad)
 Interface (Netrunner)
 Jury R.g (Techie)
 Medical Tech (Medtechie)
 Resources (Corp)
 Streetdeal (Fixer)

ATTR

Personal Grooming
 Wardrobe & Style

BODY

Endurance
 Strength Feat
 Swimming

COOL/WILL

Interrogation
 Intimide
 Oratory
 Resist Torture/Drugs
 Streetwise

EMPATHY

Human Perception
 Interview
 Leadership
 Seduction
 Social
 Persuasion & Fast Talk
 Perform

INT

Accounting
 Anthropology
 Awareness/Notice
 Biology
 Botany
 Chemistry
 Composition
 Diagnose Illness
 Education & Gen. Know
 Expert
 Gamble
 Geology
 Hide/Evade
 History
 Know Language (choose)
 Library Search
 Mathematics
 Physics
 Programming
 Shadow/Track
 Stock Market
 System Knowledge
 Teaching
 Wilderness Survival
 Zoology

REF

Archery
 Athletics
 Brawling
 Dance
 Dodge & Escape
 Driving
 Fencing
 Handgun
 Heavy Weapons
 Martial Art (choose type)
 Melee
 Motorcycle
 Operate Hvy. Machinery
 Pilot (Gyro)
 Pilot (Fixed Wing)
 Pilot (Dirigible)
 Pilot (Vect. Thrust Vehicle)
 Rifle
 Stealth
 Submachinegun

TECH

Aero Tech
 AV Tech
 Basic Tech
 Cryotank Operation
 Cyberdeck Design
 CyberTech
 Demolitions
 Disguise
 Electronics
 Elect. Security
 First Aid
 Forgery
 Gyro Tech
 Paint or Draw
 Photo & Film
 Pharmaceuticals
 Pick Lock
 Pick Pocket
 Play Instrument
 Weaponsmith

Fast and Dirty Expendables

As you'll soon realize, the *Cyberpunk* character generation system is designed to give you a lot of flexibility. You can tailor the character the way you want it, with lots of personal touches all through the process.

But when you need to generate a horde of faceless boostergangers, you're not going to want to invest this kind of time and energy. Instead, you'll need something fast and easy to help you create endless supplies of baddies to be mowed down like chaff by your player characters.

The five step **FAST CHARACTER SYSTEM** below allows you to generate a large supply of faceless guards, killers, corps and bad guys on demand. A quick run through Lifepath can create a fast and dirty background to match your fast and dirty NPCs. So go ahead and waste 'em! *We'll make more!*

Step One: Generate Stats

1) Roll 2D6 nine times, writing down each roll. If a roll is 11 or greater, reroll that value. Place each number in one Stat until all Stats are filled.

Step 2: Pick a Role & Skills

1) Select a role for the character. Write its Career Skill Package (pg.44) in the appropriate space, dividing 40 points between these skills.

2) If the character is an advanced NPC, roll an additional 2D10 and distribute these points among 5 pickup skills.

Step 3: Pick Cyberware (see pgs. 76-79)

Roll 1D10. Solos roll 6 times. All others roll 3 times. If duplicate rolls, re-roll.

1) Cyberoptics (Roll 1D6 for type)

- 1 Infrared
- 2 Lowlight
- 3 Camera
- 4 Dartgun
- 5 Antidazzle
- 6 Targeting scope

2) Cyberarm with gun (Roll 1D6 for type)

- 1 Med. Pistol
- 2 Light Pistol

- 3 Med. Pistol
- 4 Light Submachinegun
- 5 Very Heavy Pistol
- 6 Heavy Pistol

3) Cyberaudio (Roll 1D6 for type)

- 1 Wearman™
- 2 Radio Splice
- 3 Phone link
- 4 Amplified Hearing
- 5 Sound Editing
- 6 Digital Recording Link

4) Big Knucks

5) Rippers

6) Vampires

7) Slice n'dice

8) Reflex Boost (Kerenzikov)

9) Reflex Boost (Sandevistan)

10) Nothing

Step 4: Armor & Weapons

Roll 1D10, adding modifier below:

Roll	Armor	Weapon
1	Heavy Leather	Knife
2	Armor Vest	Light Pistol
3	Light Armor Jacket	Medium Pistol
4	Light Armor Jacket	Heavy Pistol
5	Med Armor Jacket	Heavy Pistol
6	Med. Armor Jacket	Light SMG
7	Med. Armor Jacket	Lt. Assault Rifle
8	Hvy. Armor Jacket	Med. Assault Rifle
9	Hvy. Armor Jacket	Hvy. Assault Rifle
+10	MetalGear™	Hvy. Assault Rifle

- Rockers, Corps, Netrunners, Fixers, Techies: add 0 to roll.
- Nomads, Cops: add +2 to roll.
- Solos: add +3 to roll.

Step 5: Write it down.

Fill out an NPC (Non-player Character) sheet, as shown below:

NAME		ROLE	
STATS			
INT []	REF [/]	TECH []	COOL []
ATTR []	LUCK []	MA []	BODY []
EMP [/]	Run []	Leap []	Lift []
Location	Head	Torso	R.Arm
	1	2-4	5
Armor SP			
SAVE	BTM	LIGHT	HEAVY
		Stun=0	Stun=1
		Stun=2	Stun=3
		Stun=4	Stun=5
		Stun=6	Stun=7
		Stun=8	Stun=9
Cybernetics			
Special Ability			
Skills			
Possessions			

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NAME		ROLE	
-------------	--	-------------	--

STATS			
INT []	REF [/]	TECH []	COOL []
ATTR []	LUCK []	MA []	BODY []
EMP [/]	Run []	Leap []	Lift []

Location	Head 1	Torso 2-4	R.Arm 5	L.Arm 6	R.Leg 7-8	L.Leg 9-0
Armor SP						

SAVE	BTM	LIGHT	SERIOUS	CRITICAL	MORTALO	MORTAL1
		Stun=0	Stun=-1	Stun=-2	Stun=-3	Stun=-4
		MORTAL 2	MORTAL3	MORTAL4	MORTAL 5	MORTAL 6
		Stun=-5	Stun=-6	Stun=-7	Stun=-8	Stun=-9

Cybernetics

Special Ability

Skills

Possessions

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NAME		ROLE	
-------------	--	-------------	--

STATS			
INT []	REF [/]	TECH []	COOL []
ATTR []	LUCK []	MA []	BODY []
EMP [/]	Run []	Leap []	Lift []

Location	Head 1	Torso 2-4	R.Arm 5	L.Arm 6	R.Leg 7-8	L.Leg 9-0
Armor SP						

SAVE	BTM	LIGHT	SERIOUS	CRITICAL	MORTALO	MORTAL1
		Stun=0	Stun=-1	Stun=-2	Stun=-3	Stun=-4
		MORTAL 2	MORTAL3	MORTAL4	MORTAL 5	MORTAL 6
		Stun=-5	Stun=-6	Stun=-7	Stun=-8	Stun=-9

Cybernetics

Special Ability

Skills

Possessions

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NAME		ROLE	
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STATS			
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ATTR []	LUCK []	MA []	BODY []
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Location	Head 1	Torso 2-4	R.Arm 5	L.Arm 6	R.Leg 7-8	L.Leg 9-0
Armor SP						

SAVE	BTM	LIGHT	SERIOUS	CRITICAL	MORTALO	MORTAL1
		Stun=0	Stun=-1	Stun=-2	Stun=-3	Stun=-4
		MORTAL 2	MORTAL3	MORTAL4	MORTAL 5	MORTAL 6
		Stun=-5	Stun=-6	Stun=-7	Stun=-8	Stun=-9

Cybernetics

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NAME		ROLE	
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STATS			
INT []	REF [/]	TECH []	COOL []
ATTR []	LUCK []	MA []	BODY []
EMP [/]	Run []	Leap []	Lift []

Location	Head 1	Torso 2-4	R.Arm 5	L.Arm 6	R.Leg 7-8	L.Leg 9-0
Armor SP						

SAVE	BTM	LIGHT	SERIOUS	CRITICAL	MORTALO	MORTAL1
		Stun=0	Stun=-1	Stun=-2	Stun=-3	Stun=-4
		MORTAL 2	MORTAL3	MORTAL4	MORTAL 5	MORTAL 6
		Stun=-5	Stun=-6	Stun=-7	Stun=-8	Stun=-9

Cybernetics

Special Ability

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ROLES
CHARACTERS
LIFEPATH
TASK & SKILLS
WEAPONS
ARMOR
GEAR
CYBERWEAR
COMBAT
MEDICAL
NETRUNNING

